

BENATUSSIL EXPECTORANT

Description

A clear, brown liquid.

Composition

Each 5 ml contains:

12.5 mg Diphenhydramine Hydrochloride

100 mg Ammonium Chloride

7.5 mg Methylparaben

Pharmacodynamics

Ammonium chloride is used as an expectorant.

Diphenhydramine is an ethanolamine derivative with the actions and uses of the histamine H₁-receptor antagonist.

Pharmacokinetics

Ammonium chloride is absorbed from the gastro-intestinal tract. The ammonium ion is converted into urea in the liver, the anion thus liberated into the blood stream and extracellular fluid causes a metabolic acidosis and decreases the pH of the urine; this is followed by transient diuresis. Diphenhydramine is well absorbed from the gastro-intestinal tract, though high first-pass metabolism appears to affect systemic availability.

Peak plasma concentrations are achieved about 1 to 4 hours after administration by mouth.

Diphenhydramine is widely distributed throughout the body including the CNS. It crosses the placenta and has been detected in breast milk. Diphenhydramine is highly bound to plasma proteins. Metabolism is extensive. Diphenhydramine is excreted mainly in the urine as metabolites, little is excreted as unchanged drug. Excretion is almost complete within 24 hours of administration. The elimination half-life has been reported to range from 2.4 to 9.3 hours.

Indication

For the control of cough and alleviation of nasal stuffiness, sneezing, lachrymation and bronchial congestion.

WARNING

When used for treatment of cough and cold:

(a) Not to be used in children less than 2 years of age

(b) To be used with caution and doctor's/ pharmacist's advice in children 2 to 6 years of age.

Precautions

If medication causes drowsiness, avoid activities requiring alertness. Possible additive effect if used with hypnotics, sedative or tranquilizers. Preparations containing diphenhydramine should not be given to patient receiving monoamine oxidase inhibitors.

Avoid driving a motor vehicle or operating heavy machinery, or drinking alcoholic beverages. A persistent cough may be a sign of a serious condition. If cough persists for more than one week, tends to recur, or is accompanied by high fever, rash or persistent headache, consult a physician.

If pregnant, consult your physician before taking this, or any medicine. If nursing, consult your physician before taking this, or any medicine.

Side Effects

Headache, photosensitivity, ataxia, chills, fatigue, diaphoresis, menstrual disease, hypotention, palpitations, tachycardia, constipation, diarrhoea, anorexia, dry mouth, dry throat, dyspepsia, nausea, vomiting, stomach discomfort, agitation/ excitation, anxiety, confusion, euphoria, excitement, convulsion, psychosis (mental disorder), disturbed coordination, dizziness, hallucinations, insomnia, irritability, nervousness, paresthesia, somnolence/ sedation, tremor, neuritis, seizure, vertigo, impaired performance (impaired driving performance, poor work performance, incoordination, reduced motor skills and impaired information processing), appetite stimulation, muscle dyskinesias and activation of epileptogenic foci, dryness of nose, thickening of bronchial secretions, tightness of chest or throat, wheezing, shortness of breath, breathing difficulty, nasal congestion, constriction of pharynx, acute labyrinthitis, pruritis, rash, itching, urticaria, anaphylactic shock, swelling of the face, lips, tongue or other parts of the body, agranulocytosis, haemolytic anaemia, thrombocytopenia, dryness of the eyes, blurred vision, tinnitus, diplopia, urinary hesitancy and retention. Somnolence was the most frequently reported adverse effect.

Drug interactions

DRUG	EFFECT
Alcohol Barbiturates Hypnotics Opioid analgesics Anxiolytic sedatives and neuroleptics	Enhanced sedation.
Monoamine oxidase inhibitors	Increased anticholinergic adverse effects.
Antimuscarinic drugs	Enhanced antimuscarinic effects.
Aminoglycoside antibiotics	Masked symptoms of ototoxicity.
Diagnostic skin test using Allergen extracts	Produces false-negative result; it is recommended that medication be discontinued at least 72 hours before testing begins.
Tricyclic antidepressants (TCAs)	Increased anticholinergic adverse effects
Beta Blockers such as metoprolol	Potentiate the effects of Diphenhydramine due to inhibition of CYP2D6.
CNS depressants (hypnotics, sedative, tranquilisers, TCAs)	Additive effects with other CNS depressants.

Pregnancy and lactation

Diphenhydramine is known to cross the placenta and has been detected in breast milk. In view of the potential risks versus small benefits, it is recommended that Benatussil Expectorant should not be used during pregnancy and lactation particularly as the safety of Benatussil Expectorant in human pregnancy and during lactation is not established.

Dosage and administration

Adults : 10ml every four to six hours. Do not exceed 60ml in 24 hours

Children (2 to 5 years) : 2.5mL every four to six hours. Do not exceed 15ml in 24 hours

Children (6-12 years): 5ml every four to six hours. Do not exceed 30ml in 24 hours.

Route of administration

Oral administration

Contraindications

This medication is contraindicated for use in patients with:

- Known hypersensitivity or idiosyncratic reaction to diphenhydramine (or substances of similar chemical structure) or ammonium chloride or any of the other ingredients in the product;
- Narrow-angle glaucoma;
- Asthma;
- Symptomatic prostatic hypertrophy;
- Presence of impaired hepatic/ renal function;
- monoamine oxidase inhibitors (MAOIs) therapy;
- stenosing peptic ulcer;
- bladder neck obstruction;
- pyloroduodenal obstruction;
- porphyria.

This medication is also contraindicated for use in:

- Premature infants or neonates;
- Children under the age of 2 years.

Overdosage

In case of accidental overdosage seek professional assistance (consult a physician) or contact the nearest general hospital immediately.

Effects on Ability to Drive and Operate Machinery

Benatussil Expectorant may cause drowsiness and the patients so affected should not drive or operate machinery.

Storage conditions

Store below 30°C.

Keep container tightly closed.

Protect from light.

Presentation

HDPE bottles of 60, 90 and 120ml

Manufactured by

Noripharma Sdn. Bhd. 200701034604 (792633-A)

Lot 5030, Jalan Teratai,

5 1/2 Mile off Jalan Meru,

41050 Klang

Selangor

Date of revision

November 2022